Verified

FIFA World Cup

The FIFA World Cup began in Uruguay in 1930. It was not played in 1942 or 1946 because of the Second World War and its aftermath. The competition expanded over time from 13 teams in 1930 to 48 teams in 2026.

FIFA World Cup editions, 1930 onward

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
2026	Canada, Mexico and United States	48	**Spain**	Argentina	England	France	Spain 1–0 Argentina (a.e.t.)	19 July 2026	Kylian Mbappé (France, 10 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Spain won its second title in 2026.

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
2022	Qatar	32	**Argentina**	France	Croatia	Morocco	Argentina 3–3 France; 4–2 pens	18 December 2022	Kylian Mbappé (France, 8 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Argentina and France played a 3–3 final in 2022 before Argentina won the shoot-out.
2018	Russia	32	**France**	Croatia	Belgium	England	France 4–2 Croatia	15 July 2018	Harry Kane (England, 6 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Croatia reached its first final in 2018.

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
2014	Brazil	32	Germany	Argentina	Netherlands	Brazil	Germany 1–0 Argentina (a.e.t.)	13 July 2014	James Rodríguez (Colombia, 6 goals)	—
2010	South Africa	32	Spain	Netherlands	Germany	Uruguay	Spain 1–0 Netherlands (a.e.t.)	11 July 2010	Thomas Müller (Germany, 5 goals)	—
2006	Germany	32	Italy	France	Germany	Portugal	Italy 1–1 France; 5–3 pens	9 July 2006	Miroslav Klose (Germany, 5 goals)	—
2002	South Korea and Japan	32	Brazil	Germany	Türkiye	South Korea	Brazil 2–0 Germany	30 June 2002	Ronaldo (Brazil, 8 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
1998	France	32	**France**	Brazil	Croatia	Netherlands	France 3–0 Brazil	12 July 1998	Davor Šuker (Croatia, 6 goals)	—
1994	United States	24	**Brazil**	Italy	Sweden	Bulgaria	Brazil 0–0 Italy; 3–2 pens	17 July 1994	Hristo Stoichkov; Oleg Salenko (Bulgaria; Russia, 6 goals)	—
1990	Italy	24	**West Germany**	Argentina	Italy	England	West Germany 1–0 Argentina	8 July 1990	Salvatore Schillaci (Italy, 6 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
1986	Mexico	24	**Argentina**	West Germany	France	Belgium	Argentina 3–2 West Germany	29 June 1986	Gary Lineker (England, 6 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Diego Maradona inspired Argentina in 1986.
1982	Spain	24	**Italy**	West Germany	Poland	France	Italy 3–1 West Germany	11 July 1982	Paolo Rossi (Italy, 6 goals)	—
1978	Argentina	16	**Argentina**	Netherlands	Brazil	Italy	Argentina 3–1 Netherlands (a.e.t.)	25 June 1978	Mario Kempes (Argentina, 6 goals)	—
1974	West Germany	16	**West Germany**	Netherlands	Poland	Brazil	West Germany 2–1 Netherlands	7 July 1974	Grzegorz Lato (Poland, 7 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
1970	Mexico	16	**Brazil**	Italy	West Germany	Uruguay	Brazil 4–1 Italy	21 June 1970	Gerd Müller (West Germany, 10 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Brazil's 1970 side became the first team to win three World Cups.
1966	England	16	**England**	West Germany	Portugal	Soviet Union	England 4–2 West Germany (a.e.t.)	30 July 1966	Eusébio (Portugal, 9 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
1962	Chile	16	Brazil	Czechoslovakia	Chile	Yugoslavia	Brazil 3–1 Czechoslovakia	17 June 1962	Garrincha; Vavá; Leonel Sánchez; Flórián Albert; Valentin Ivanov; Dražan Jerković (Multiple, 4 goals)	—
1958	Sweden	16	Brazil	Sweden	France	West Germany	Brazil 5–2 Sweden	29 June 1958	Just Fontaine (France, 13 goals)	—
1954	Switzerland	16	West Germany	Hungary	Austria	Uruguay	West Germany 3–2 Hungary	4 July 1954	Sándor Kocsis (Hungary, 11 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
1950	Brazil	13	**Uruguay**	Brazil	Sweden	Spain	Uruguay 2–1 Brazil (final-group decider)	16 July 1950	Ademir (Brazil, 9 goals)	▶ 📖 Tap to read the story Uruguay defeated Brazil in the decisive 1950 match at the Maracanã, a result remembered as the *Maracanazo*.
1938	France	15	**Italy**	Hungary	Brazil	Sweden	Italy 4–2 Hungary	19 June 1938	Leônidas (Brazil, 7 goals)	—

Year	Host(s)	Teams	Winner	Runner-up	Third	Fourth / other semifinalist	Final	Final date	Top scorer	Story
1934	Italy	16	Italy	Czechoslovakia	Germany	Austria	Italy 2–1 Czechoslovakia (a.e.t.)	10 June 1934	Oldřich Nejedlý (Czechoslovakia, 5 goals)	—
1930	Uruguay	13	Uruguay	Argentina	United States	Yugoslavia	Uruguay 4–2 Argentina	30 July 1930	Guillermo Stábile (Argentina, 8 goals)	—

Podium by edition

2026

Hosted by Canada, Mexico and United States

🥇 **Spain**
🥈 Argentina
🥉 England
4. France

2022

Hosted by Qatar

🥇 **Argentina**
🥈 France
🥉 Croatia
4. Morocco

2018

Hosted by Russia

🥇 **France**
🥈 Croatia
🥉 Belgium
4. England

2014

Hosted by Brazil

🥇 **Germany**
🥈 Argentina
🥉 Netherlands
4. Brazil

2010

Hosted by South Africa

🥇 **Spain**
🥈 Netherlands
🥉 Germany
4. Uruguay

2006

Hosted by Germany

🥇 **Italy**
🥈 France
🥉 Germany
4. Portugal

2002

Hosted by South Korea and Japan

🥇 **Brazil**
🥈 Germany
🥉 Türkiye
4. South Korea

1998

Hosted by France

🥇 **France**
🥈 Brazil
🥉 Croatia
4. Netherlands

1994

Hosted by United States

🥇 **Brazil**
🥈 Italy
🥉 Sweden
4. Bulgaria

1990

Hosted by Italy

🥇 **West Germany**
🥈 Argentina
🥉 Italy
4. England

1986

Hosted by Mexico

🥇 **Argentina**
🥈 West Germany
🥉 France
4. Belgium

1982

Hosted by Spain

🥇 **Italy**
🥈 West Germany
🥉 Poland
4. France

1978

Hosted by Argentina

🥇 **Argentina**
🥈 Netherlands
🥉 Brazil
4. Italy

1974

Hosted by West Germany

🥇 **West Germany**
🥈 Netherlands
🥉 Poland
4. Brazil

1970

Hosted by Mexico

🥇 **Brazil**
🥈 Italy
🥉 West Germany
4. Uruguay

1966

Hosted by England

🥇 **England**
🥈 West Germany
🥉 Portugal
4. Soviet Union

1962

Hosted by Chile

🥇 **Brazil**
🥈 Czechoslovakia
🥉 Chile
4. Yugoslavia

1958

Hosted by Sweden

🥇 **Brazil**
🥈 Sweden
🥉 France
4. West Germany

1954

Hosted by Switzerland

🥇 **West Germany**
🥈 Hungary
🥉 Austria
4. Uruguay

1950

Hosted by Brazil

🥇 **Uruguay**
🥈 Brazil
🥉 Sweden
4. Spain

1938

Hosted by France

🥇 **Italy**
🥈 Hungary
🥉 Brazil
4. Sweden

1934

Hosted by Italy

🥇 **Italy**
🥈 Czechoslovakia
🥉 Germany
4. Austria

1930

Hosted by Uruguay

🥇 **Uruguay**
🥈 Argentina
🥉 United States
4. Yugoslavia

🏆 Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Brazil — **5**

1958, 1962, 1970, 1994, 2002

Italy — **4**

1934, 1938, 1982, 2006

Germany (incl. West Germany) — **4**

1954, 1974, 1990, 2014

Argentina — **3**

1978, 1986, 2022

Uruguay — **2**

1930, 1950

France 2

1998, 2018

Spain 2

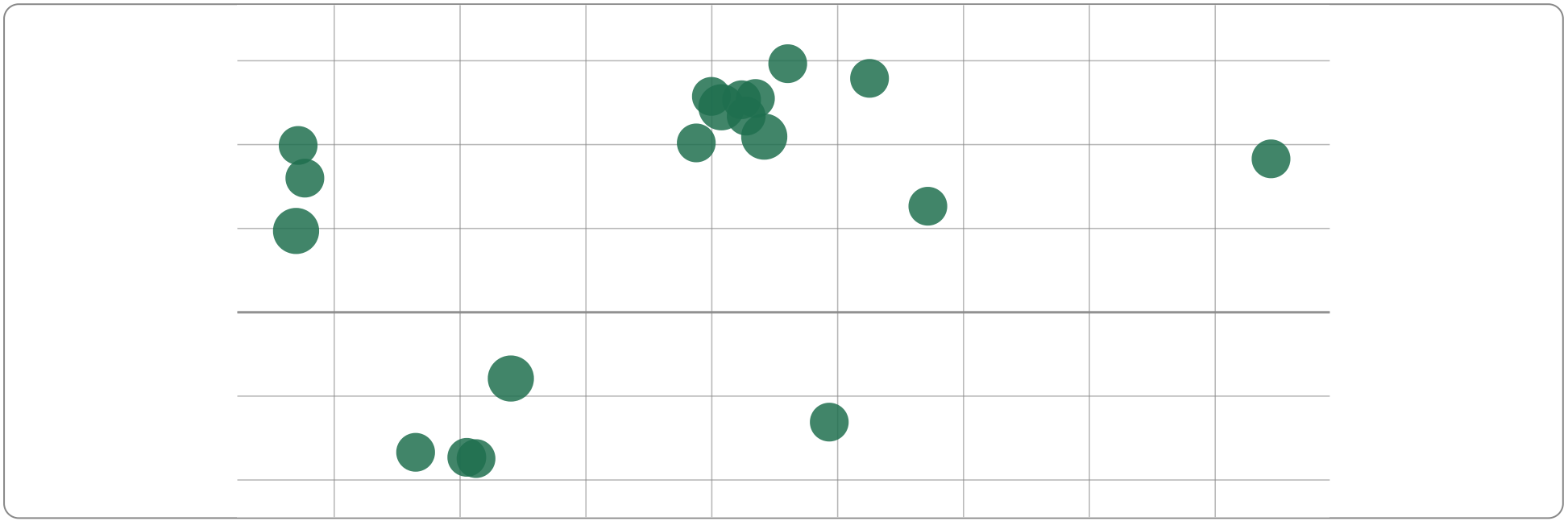
2010, 2026

England 1

1966

Where the tournament has been hosted

Every host country's approximate location on a simple latitude/longitude grid, grouped by region in the list below - not a claim of exact borders, just roughly where in the world each edition took place. Bigger dots hosted more than once.



South America **Europe** **North America** **Asia**

Uruguay 1 time
1930

Brazil 2 times
1950, 2014

Chile 1 time
1962

Argentina 1 time
1978

Italy 2 times
1934, 1990

France 2 times
1938, 1998

Switzerland 1 time
1954

Sweden 1 time
1958

England 1 time
1966

West Germany 1 time
1974

Spain 1 time
1982

Germany 1 time
2006

Russia 1 time
2018

Mexico 2 times
1970, 1986

United States 1 time
1994

Canada, Mexico and United States 1 time
2026

South Korea and Japan 1 time
2002

Qatar 1 time
2022

Africa

South Africa 1 time
2010

ℹ️ How it works

- National teams first play years of qualifying matches within their own confederation to win one of a limited number of finals places.
- The finals begin with a group stage, where each team plays the others in its group; the leading teams advance.

- From the round of 32 onward (the round of 16 before the 48-team expansion in 2026), it is a straight knockout: one defeat and a team is out.
- The two semifinal winners meet in the final to decide the champion.
- The tournament has expanded several times since 1930 - see "Format milestones" below for exactly when.

📝 Final venues

Every World Cup edition has decided its champion in one match at one stadium, including 1950's final-group decider between Uruguay and Brazil (see "Format milestones" below) - unlike Copa América, no era of this competition has settled the title by league table or a two-legged tie. A reported attendance figure is added below where it could be confirmed via two independent sources - 21 of the 23 editions clear that bar. 1930 and 1950 are left without one despite being extensively documented: both are genuinely disputed rather than merely unconfirmed, since their most commonly cited figures split between an official/paid count and a larger total-inside-the-stadium estimate, and no single number can be presented as fact.

- **1930:** Estadio Centenario, Montevideo (Uruguay).
- **1934:** Stadio Nazionale PNF, Rome (Italy) - a reported attendance of 55,000.
- **1938:** Stade Olympique de Colombes, Colombes, near Paris (France) - a reported attendance of 45,000.
- **1950:** Estádio do Maracanã, Rio de Janeiro (Brazil).
- **1954:** Wankdorf Stadium, Bern (Switzerland) - a reported attendance of 62,500.
- **1958:** Råsunda Stadium, Solna, near Stockholm (Sweden) - a reported attendance of 49,737.
- **1962:** Estadio Nacional, Santiago (Chile) - a reported attendance of 68,679.
- **1966:** Wembley Stadium, London (England) - a reported attendance of 96,924.
- **1970:** Estadio Azteca, Mexico City (Mexico) - a reported attendance of 107,412.
- **1974:** Olympiastadion, Munich (West Germany) - a reported attendance of 78,200.
- **1978:** Estadio Monumental, Buenos Aires (Argentina) - a reported attendance of 71,483.
- **1982:** Santiago Bernabéu, Madrid (Spain) - a reported attendance of 90,089.
- **1986:** Estadio Azteca, Mexico City (Mexico) - the same stadium as the 1970 final, the first to host two World Cup finals, with a reported attendance of 114,600, the largest of any World Cup final.

- **1990:** Stadio Olimpico, Rome (Italy) - a reported attendance of 73,603.
- **1994:** Rose Bowl, Pasadena, California (United States) - a reported attendance of 94,194.
- **1998:** Stade de France, Saint-Denis (France) - a reported attendance of 80,000.
- **2002:** International Stadium Yokohama, Yokohama (Japan) - a reported attendance of 69,029.
- **2006:** Olympiastadion, Berlin (Germany) - a reported attendance of 69,000.
- **2010:** Soccer City, Johannesburg (South Africa) - renamed FNB Stadium after the tournament, with a reported attendance of 84,490.
- **2014:** Estádio do Maracanã, Rio de Janeiro (Brazil) - the same stadium as the 1950 final, with a reported attendance of 74,738.
- **2018:** Luzhniki Stadium, Moscow (Russia) - a reported attendance of 78,011.
- **2022:** Lusail Stadium, Lusail (Qatar) - a reported attendance of 88,966.
- **2026:** MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford, New Jersey (United States) - a reported attendance of 80,663.

📝 Format milestones

- **1930:** 13 teams played the first edition.
- **1950:** no single final was scheduled; the decisive final-group match between Uruguay and Brazil determined the champion.
- **1982:** the field expanded from 16 to 24 teams.
- **1998:** the field expanded to 32 teams.
- **2026:** the field expanded to 48 teams and was hosted by three countries for the first time.

📝 Golden Ball winners

- FIFA has named a best-player award at every World Cup since 1982; no equivalent award existed at earlier editions.
- **1982:** Paolo Rossi (Italy) - the award's first winner.
- **1986:** Diego Maradona (Argentina).
- **1990:** Salvatore Schillaci (Italy).
- **1994:** Romário (Brazil).
- **1998:** Ronaldo (Brazil).

- **2002:** Oliver Kahn (Germany) - the only goalkeeper to date to also win the award.
- **2006:** Zinedine Zidane (France).
- **2010:** Diego Forlán (Uruguay).
- **2014:** Lionel Messi (Argentina) - the first of his two wins, still the only player to win the award more than once.
- **2018:** Luka Modrić (Croatia).
- **2022:** Lionel Messi (Argentina) - his second win.
- **2026:** Rodri (Spain) - the first Spain player to win the award.

📝 Silver Ball and Bronze Ball winners

- The two runners-up in the Golden Ball voting receive the Silver Ball and Bronze Ball; both have been awarded alongside the Golden Ball at every World Cup since 1982.
- **1982:** Falcão (Brazil) won the Silver Ball; Karl-Heinz Rummenigge (West Germany) won the Bronze Ball.
- **1986:** Harald Schumacher (West Germany) won the Silver Ball; Preben Elkjær (Denmark) won the Bronze Ball.
- **1990:** Lothar Matthäus (West Germany) won the Silver Ball; Diego Maradona (Argentina) won the Bronze Ball.
- **1994:** Roberto Baggio (Italy) won the Silver Ball; Hristo Stoichkov (Bulgaria) won the Bronze Ball.
- **1998:** Davor Šuker (Croatia) won the Silver Ball; Lilian Thuram (France) won the Bronze Ball.
- **2002:** Ronaldo (Brazil) won the Silver Ball; Hong Myung-bo (South Korea) won the Bronze Ball.
- **2006:** Fabio Cannavaro (Italy) won the Silver Ball; Andrea Pirlo (Italy) won the Bronze Ball.
- **2010:** Wesley Sneijder (Netherlands) won the Silver Ball; David Villa (Spain) won the Bronze Ball.
- **2014:** Thomas Müller (Germany) won the Silver Ball; Arjen Robben (Netherlands) won the Bronze Ball.
- **2018:** Eden Hazard (Belgium) won the Silver Ball; Antoine Griezmann (France) won the Bronze Ball.
- **2022:** Kylian Mbappé (France) won the Silver Ball; Luka Modrić (Croatia) won the Bronze Ball.
- **2026:** Lionel Messi (Argentina) won the Silver Ball despite Argentina's final defeat; Kylian Mbappé (France) won the Bronze Ball.

📝 Golden Glove winners

- FIFA has named a best-goalkeeper award at every World Cup since 1994; no equivalent award existed in earlier editions.
- **1994:** Michel Preud'homme (Belgium) - the award's first winner, then named the Lev Yashin Award.
- **1998:** Fabien Barthez (France).
- **2002:** Oliver Kahn (Germany) - the only goalkeeper to date to also win the tournament's Golden Ball as best overall player.
- **2006:** Gianluigi Buffon (Italy).
- **2010:** Iker Casillas (Spain) - the first winner under the award's current "Golden Glove" name, adopted that year.
- **2014:** Manuel Neuer (Germany).
- **2018:** Thibaut Courtois (Belgium).
- **2022:** Emiliano Martínez (Argentina).
- **2026:** Unai Simón (Spain) - a record seven clean sheets across the tournament.

📝 Young Player Award winners

- FIFA has named a best-player-aged-21-or-under award at every World Cup since 2006; no equivalent award existed at earlier editions.
- **2006:** Lukas Podolski (Germany) - the award's first winner.
- **2010:** Thomas Müller (Germany).
- **2014:** Paul Pogba (France).
- **2018:** Kylian Mbappé (France).
- **2022:** Enzo Fernández (Argentina).
- **2026:** Pau Cubarsí (Spain) - the first defender to win the award.

📝 Fair Play Award winners

- FIFA has named a team Fair Play Award, based on each squad's on-field disciplinary record, at every World Cup since 1970; no equivalent award existed at the eight earlier editions. Awarded to a single team except in 1998 and 2006, the only two editions with a tie.
- **1970:** Peru - the award's first winner.
- **1974:** West Germany.

- **1978:** Argentina.
- **1982:** Brazil.
- **1986:** Brazil.
- **1990:** England.
- **1994:** Brazil.
- **1998:** England and France - the award's first of two shared years.
- **2002:** Belgium.
- **2006:** Brazil and Spain - the award's second and, to date, final shared year.
- **2010:** Spain - the fifth team to win both the World Cup and the Fair Play Award at the same tournament, after West Germany (1974), Argentina (1978), Brazil (1994) and France (1998, a shared award year).
- **2014:** Colombia.
- **2018:** Spain.
- **2022:** England.
- **2026:** Netherlands.

📝 Winning managers

- Every World Cup-winning team has been led by a manager of the same nationality as the team itself, a pattern unbroken across all 23 editions.
- **1930:** Alberto Suppici (Uruguay) - the youngest winning manager in World Cup history, aged 31.
- **1934:** Vittorio Pozzo (Italy).
- **1938:** Vittorio Pozzo (Italy) - still the only manager to win the World Cup twice, and the only one to win it back-to-back.
- **1950:** Juan López Fontana (Uruguay).
- **1954:** Sepp Herberger (West Germany).
- **1958:** Vicente Feola (Brazil).
- **1962:** Aymoré Moreira (Brazil).

- **1966:** Alf Ramsey (England).
- **1970:** Mário Zagallo (Brazil) - also won the trophy as a player in 1958 and 1962, and later won the Copa América as Brazil's manager in 1997.
- **1974:** Helmut Schön (West Germany) - also won the 1972 UEFA European Championship as West Germany's manager.
- **1978:** César Luis Menotti (Argentina).
- **1982:** Enzo Bearzot (Italy).
- **1986:** Carlos Bilardo (Argentina).
- **1990:** Franz Beckenbauer (West Germany) - also won the trophy as a player in 1974, one of only three men to win it as both player and manager.
- **1994:** Carlos Alberto Parreira (Brazil) - also won the Copa América as Brazil's manager in 2004.
- **1998:** Aimé Jacquet (France).
- **2002:** Luiz Felipe Scolari (Brazil).
- **2006:** Marcello Lippi (Italy).
- **2010:** Vicente del Bosque (Spain) - also won the UEFA European Championship as Spain's manager in 2012.
- **2014:** Joachim Löw (Germany).
- **2018:** Didier Deschamps (France) - also won the trophy as a player in 1998, joining Zagallo and Beckenbauer as a player-and-manager winner.
- **2022:** Lionel Scaloni (Argentina).
- **2026:** Luis de la Fuente (Spain) - the oldest winning manager in World Cup history, aged 65, and Spain's second title alongside 2010. He also won the 2023 UEFA Nations League and the 2024 UEFA European Championship as Spain's manager.

📝 Winning captains

- The captain is the player who lifts the trophy on the podium; every World Cup-winning team has had one across all 23 editions.
- **1930:** José Nasazzi (Uruguay).
- **1934:** Gianpiero Combi (Italy).

- **1938:** Giuseppe Meazza (Italy).
- **1950:** Obdulio Varela (Uruguay).
- **1954:** Fritz Walter (West Germany).
- **1958:** Hilderaldo Bellini (Brazil).
- **1962:** Mauro Ramos (Brazil).
- **1966:** Bobby Moore (England).
- **1970:** Carlos Alberto Torres (Brazil).
- **1974:** Franz Beckenbauer (West Germany) - also captained West Germany to the 1972 UEFA European Championship title, and went on to win the World Cup as a manager in 1990, one of only three men to win it as both player and manager (see "Winning managers" above).
- **1978:** Daniel Passarella (Argentina).
- **1982:** Dino Zoff (Italy) - at 40 years old, still the oldest player to captain a World Cup-winning team.
- **1986:** Diego Maradona (Argentina).
- **1990:** Lothar Matthäus (West Germany).
- **1994:** Dunga (Brazil).
- **1998:** Didier Deschamps (France) - also went on to win the trophy as a manager in 2018, joining Zagallo and Beckenbauer as a player-and-manager winner (see "Winning managers" above).
- **2002:** Cafu (Brazil) - the only player to appear in three consecutive World Cup finals (1994, 1998 and 2002); also captained Brazil to the 1999 Copa América title.
- **2006:** Fabio Cannavaro (Italy).
- **2010:** Iker Casillas (Spain) - also captained Spain to the UEFA EURO title in 2008 and 2012.
- **2014:** Philipp Lahm (Germany).
- **2018:** Hugo Lloris (France).
- **2022:** Lionel Messi (Argentina) - also captained Argentina to the Copa América title in 2021 and 2024.
- **2026:** Rodri (Spain) - also named the tournament's Golden Ball winner the same year (see "Golden Ball winners" above).

🎉 Memorable moments

- Uruguay defeated Brazil in the decisive 1950 match at the Maracanã, a result remembered as the *Maracanazo*.
- Brazil's 1970 side became the first team to win three World Cups.
- Diego Maradona inspired Argentina in 1986.
- Croatia reached its first final in 2018.
- Argentina and France played a 3–3 final in 2022 before Argentina won the shoot-out.
- Spain won its second title in 2026.

📝 Editorial notes

- The 1930 tournament did not include a third-place match. FIFA's historical ranking places the United States third and Yugoslavia fourth.
- The 1950 final positions came from a four-team final group rather than semifinals and a final.
- “Germany” totals conventionally include West Germany's results.
- Display a map of host countries without using protected tournament logos.

📚 References & review

Status: verified Last reviewed:27 October 2026

- FIFA tournament history and champions (source 1 of 2) (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1930-1978-uruguay-italy-germany-brazil-england-argentina)
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- FIFA 2026 awards (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/award-winners)
- FIFA historical top scorers (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/fontaine-mbappe-ronaldo-and-more-every-world-cup-top-scorer)
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning (source 1 of 11) (https://blog.betway.com/football/world-cup/football-world-cup-winning-captains/)

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.